

CANDIDATE CARD NO. 1

MEDICINE

SETTING

Local Medical Clinic

DOCTOR

You see a 45-year-old patient who suffered a mild anterior acute myocardial infarction two weeks ago. Recovery was uncomplicated and the patient was discharged from hospital four days ago. He/she is now concerned about how much physical activity is appropriate during recovery.

TASK

- Find out reason for visit.
- Reassure patient about fatigue (e.g., expected: 4–6 weeks for return of full energy levels, etc.). Remind patient about heart attack recovery (e.g., gradual, lifestyle changes and medication to help, etc.). Emphasise importance of exercise (e.g., heart health: strengthening heart; overall health: lowering cholesterol; etc.).
- Give recommendations for exercise (moderate physical activity: patient's recovery uncomplicated, already two weeks since hospital admission, etc.). Advise importance of joining cardiac rehabilitation programme (e.g., increasing exercise tolerance under supervision, etc.). Explore patient's job (type of work, etc.).
- Give timescale for return to work (e.g., 4–6 weeks for desk job, etc.). Explain need to be physically and emotionally ready (e.g., not rushing back, planning return to work: assistance/support from employer, etc.). Explore any concerns.
- Provide recommendations for prevention of future attacks (diet: vegetables, whole grains; lifestyle: physically active; etc.). Reassure patient about his/her concerns (e.g., normal, appropriate, etc.).